

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

9th edition methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 from Best of JS curated projects

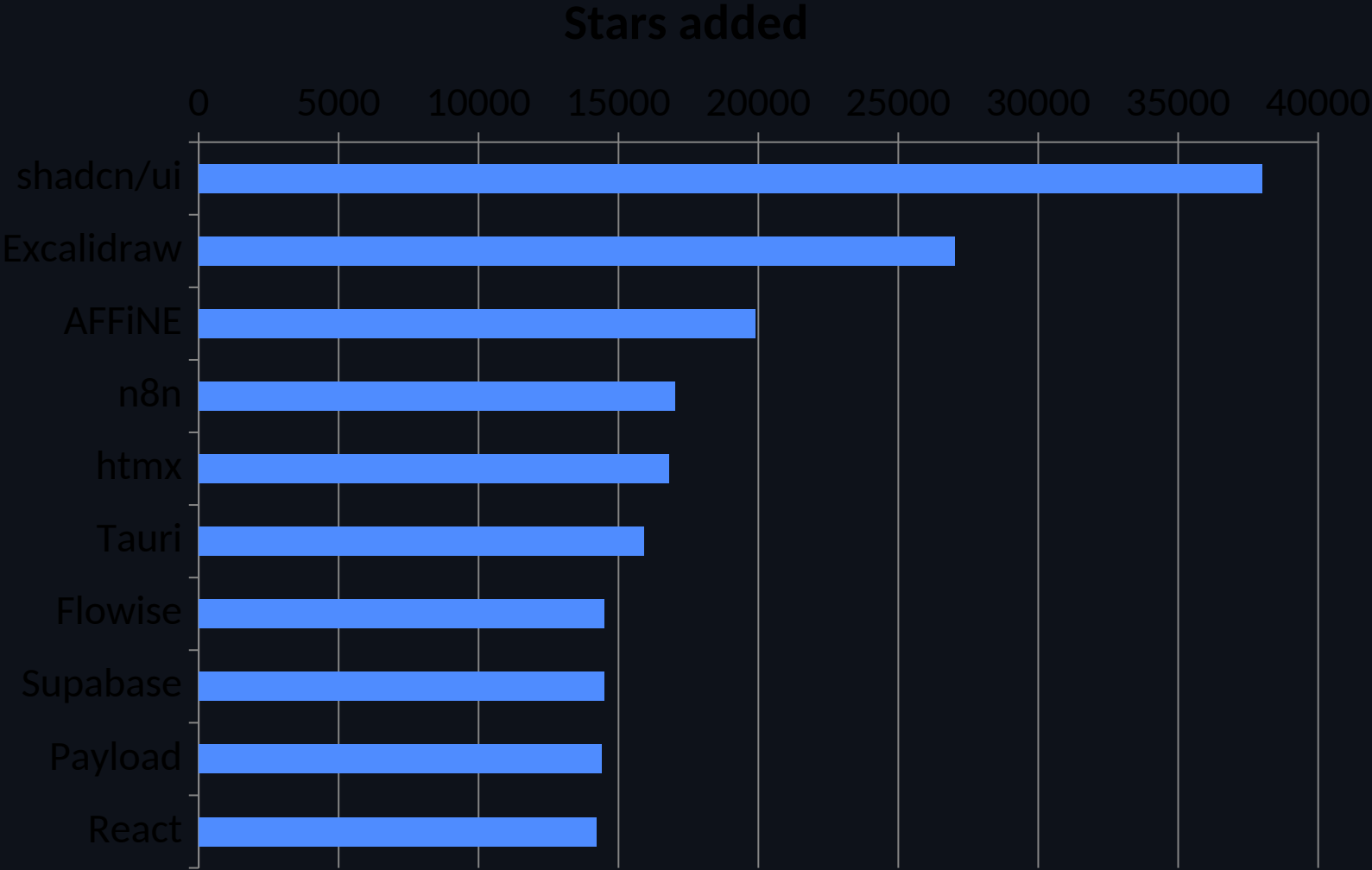
Audience: Frontend engineers and engineering managers

Goal: Identify where momentum concentrated in JS ecosystem during 2024

Headline: shadcn/ui leads overall; htmx tops frontend frameworks

Overall Top 10 by Stars Added in 2024

Gap is clear: shadcn/ui (+38.0k) materially ahead of #2 and #3



#1 shadcn/ui

+38,000 stars

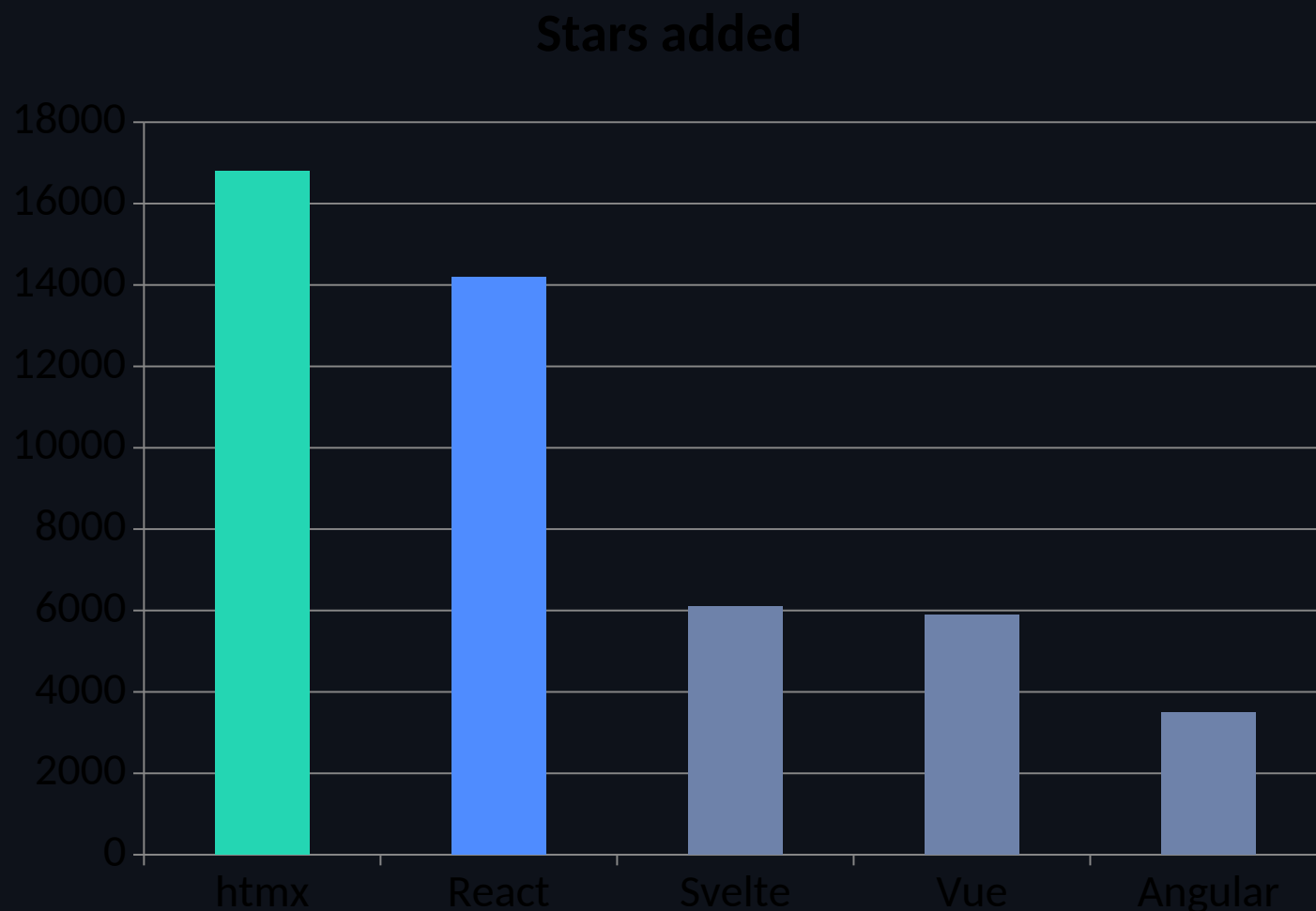
≈ +11k vs #2

shadcn/ui Deep Dive: Second Straight Year at the Top



- Trajectory: N/A (2022) → +39.5k (2023) → +38.0k (2024)
- Total stars reached ~77.5k by year-end 2024
- 2024 product pushes: Charts, Themes, Blocks, Sidebar
- New CLI expanded support across multiple frameworks
- Model validated: copy-paste + ownership beats opaque imports

Frontend Frameworks: htmx Overtakes React in 2024 Stars Added



What changed?

- htmx: HTML extension model resonates with low-JS/server-driven teams
- React 19 shipped long-awaited Server Components and Server Functions
- Svelte/Vue remain healthy with steady growth

React Ecosystem Top 5: UI and Product Tooling Dominate

Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	shadcn/ui	+38.0k
2	Excalidraw	+27.0k
3	Payload	+14.4k
4	Magic UI	+13.2k
5	Next.js	+12.1k

Interpretation

React is evolving from a single library into a framework specification. Server primitives in React 19 are interpreted differently by Next.js, Remix, and others. Winning projects blend DX, UI ownership, and production workflow value.

Vue Ecosystem Top 5: Nuxt and UI Libraries Signal Maturity



Why it matters

- Vue 3.5 reworked reactivity internals
- alien-signals approach already landed in main branch
- Strong gains in PrimeVue + shadcn-vue point to UI ecosystem confidence
- Nuxt maintains momentum through active releases and performance work

Cross-Cutting Themes: AI, Desktop, and Browser Innovation

AI-Native Builders

- n8n (+17.0k)
- Flowise (+14.5k)
- Supabase (+14.5k)

Desktop via Web Stack

- Tauri (+15.9k)

Browser Capability Frontier

- PGLite
- WebVM

Actionable Takeaways for 2025 Planning

- Adopt component ownership where customization speed matters: shadcn/ui model is durable.
- Evaluate HTML-first/server-driven architecture options: htmx momentum is now material.
- Treat React as a framework contract, not only a UI library; standardize team conventions early.
- Prioritize AI integration in developer and product workflows; it is now table stakes.
- Watch Vue ecosystem for UI platform opportunities as reactivity and tooling continue to mature.

Implication: 2025 winners will combine developer ergonomics, AI leverage, and deployable architecture choices.